Client Name:_____ SSN: _____

BEHAVIORAL HEALTH INFORMED CONSENTS AND AGREEMENTS

All The Life Link documents mentioned in this document are available on our website www.thelifelink.org/clientpaperwork or directly via this QR code. Alternatively you can request a printed copy of our Notice of Privacy Practices and/or Client Handbook to any provider or front desk staff.

Please read and review the following pages and **initial each consent to acknowledge agreement**. If you decline, write an X instead and ensure you understand the repercussions of declining. Instructions on how to revoke a consent are at the end of this document. We are here to answer any questions you may have.

1. _____ **(Initial) NOTICE OF PRIVACY PRACTICES and CLIENT HANDBOOK RECEIPT ACKNOWLEDGMENT.** I have received and had the opportunity to discuss with agency employees The Life Link's Notice of Privacy Practices, which describes how confidential health information may be used or disclosed and how to access this information. I have received and had the opportunity to discuss with agency employees The Life Link Client Handbook, which provides information and orientation regarding the following topics: The Life Link's history, mission, programs, services, locations and hours of operation; my rights and responsibilities; purpose and process of the intake assessment; how the services plans, discharge plans and crisis/safety plans are developed; the complaint and grievance procedures; access to emergency services after hours; mental health advance directives; codes of ethics and conduct (including zero tolerance to violence); methods and opportunities to provide client input; explanation of financial obligations, fees and financial arrangements; no show and cancellation policy; telehealth and in person availability (including a copy of telehealth consent); fire, safety and emergency precautions and procedures; critical incident reporting; policy on tobacco products, weapons, illicit or licit drugs brought into the program and attending services while under the influence of alcohol and/or drugs; reasonable accommodations requests; non-discrimination policy; agency's Notice of Privacy Practices and consents and agreements that are part of the intake paperwork; and steps to revoke these consents.
2. _____ **(Initial) INFORMED CONSENT AND CLIENT SERVICE AGREEMENT.** I voluntarily consent to engage in behavioral health services at The Life Link and acknowledge that no guarantees or promises have been given regarding the results of these services. I understand that developing a service plan with my providers, and regularly reviewing our work toward meeting my recovery goals, are in my best interest. I agree to play an active role in this process and attend sessions on time and follow attendance policies. Consenting to treatment is required to engage in any The Life Link service.
3. _____ **(Initial) CONSENT for USES and DISCLOSURES of TREATMENT INFORMATION FOR THE PURPOSE OF TREATMENT, PAYMENT and OPERATIONS (TPO).** I understand that my substance abuse treatment records, if applicable, are protected under federal law, including 42 CFR Part 2 and HIPAA, and any applicable state laws. I authorize The Life Link staff to share my health information for the purposes of treatment, payment and operations. This involves but is not limited to communicating with other healthcare providers and

agencies involved with my care, bill appropriate funding sources for reimbursement of my services, share my information with business associates involved in the operations of the agency and utilize The Life Link team approach in my treatment. I understand The Life Link will strive to keep any information disclosed to the minimum necessary to accomplish those tasks, including sharing information internally with those directly involved in my care. Our business associates must comply with all federal and state confidentiality laws. The details of these disclosures are described in our agency's Notice of Privacy Practices. I understand that if HIPAA covered entities and business associates receive records of treatment, payment and healthcare operation purposes, the records may be re-disclosed in accordance with HIPAA, except for use or disclosures for civil, criminal, administrative, or legislative proceedings against me. Unless I revoke this consent, this consent will take effect immediately and will expire upon revocation. I understand that I have the right to not sign this consent form or decline it. I have the right to revoke this consent in writing at any time, except to the extent that action has been taken in reliance upon it. I understand that refusal to consent may result in fragmented care, inability to coordinate my care with other providers and inability to seek payment for services (thus making myself financially responsible).

4. _____ **(Initial if you are requesting restrictions). I request the following restrictions regarding how my health information is used and disclosed:**
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5. _____ **(Initial) EMAIL AND TEXTING AUTHORIZATION.** I consent to communicating with The Life Link via email and/or text messages, such as receiving reminders of appointments and/or other communications with my providers. I understand that more secure methods of communication, like phone, fax or encrypted email, are always preferred to non-encrypted (insecure) email and/or text messaging for more sensitive protected health information (PHI). Under specific circumstances and if you choose to, insecure email and/or text messaging communication containing PHI may take place between The Life Link and myself. Staff will send the minimal necessary information, in other words just enough information to accomplish what is needed. It is my responsibility to keep The Life Link informed of changes in my contact information. I understand that whenever feasible, The Life Link staff will use encrypted emails when sending my private health information, making the transmission secure. I comprehend that if I choose to decline this consent I will not receive appointment reminders nor will I be able to communicate by text or email with my providers.

6. _____ **(Initial) TELEHEALTH CONSENT.** I consent to participate in telehealth services at The Life Link. I understand that telehealth is the practice of delivering services via technology assisted media or other electronic means between a provider and a client who are located in two different locations (such as by phone or video). I understand The Life Link services are primarily offered in person, but may occasionally be conducted via telehealth. I understand the importance of being in a private and safe environment when attending a telehealth appointment. If attending a telehealth group, I must ensure that others cannot hear what is being said by other group participants. I understand that my provider may determine that in person services may be clinically-indicated or the better format for me and may request that we change formats. I understand that there are risks, benefits, and consequences

associated with telehealth, including but not limited to disruption of transmission by technology failures, interruption and/or breaches of confidentiality by unauthorized persons, and/or limited ability to respond to emergencies. If during a telehealth session we encounter technical difficulties resulting in service interruptions I can call the main Life Link phone number at (505)438-0010 for assistance. I need to let my provider know what my location is during a telehealth appointment in order to be able to address emergencies effectively. I understand that my provider may need to communicate with my emergency contact and/or appropriate authorities in case of an emergency. I comprehend that declining this consent will lead to being unable to receive any services by phone or video.

7. _____ **(Initial) CONSENT TO BILL FOR SERVICES AND STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL RESPONSIBILITY.** I acknowledge that The Life Link will submit for reimbursement for services to my insurance and may assist me in applying for insurance coverage if I don't have any. Nevertheless, I am ultimately and fully responsible for all charges for the services I receive, including co-payments, deductibles, and services not reimbursed by my insurance. I agree to update The Life Link on any changes in my coverage. I authorize any third party to pay directly and solely to The Life Link any and all coverage for services at The Life Link. I acknowledge that failure to provide The Life Link with the information necessary to bill any applicable third party payor will result in my being designated as financially responsible for fees related to services provided. I further grant The Life Link permission to release and disclose any and all health records including alcohol and substance abuse records covered under 42 CFR, part 2 necessary for purposes of registration, determining eligibility, and billing my insurance company or other third party payment programs in which I am enrolled, and release The Life Link and any related entities, employees and Directors from any and all liability related to or arising from any such release or disclosure. The information used for the above purpose will be kept strictly confidential in accordance with all federal and state confidentiality laws. I understand that I may revoke this consent at any time: however, if I revoke my signed consent or decline to sign this consent, I may no longer be eligible for coverage by my insurance company, or other third party payment programs and could be declined as a The Life Link client if I don't pay for services myself.

8. _____ **(Initial) INFORMED CONSENT FOR THE USE ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (AI) FOR COMPLETION OF DOCUMENTATION.** Artificial Intelligence (AI) is a tool that uses computer software to perform tasks that typically require human intelligence, like writing, summarizing information, providing insights, organizing data or providing administrative support. I understand that all AI tools used at The Life Link adhere to industry HIPAA standard security practices in order to protect your privacy. Furthermore, no AI tool is used to make final decisions about my care, treatment or diagnoses. I understand that the benefits of using AI in documentation is that it allows my provider to spend less time on administrative tasks and more time focused on my care and helps create more complete and accurate records of my services.The potential risk of using AI in documentation is potential for error or bias. To reduce this risk, providers are trained to carefully review the documentation created by AI and ensure accuracy. Only my provider or authorized care team members have access to any AI-generated content. No recordings or session content are stored or reviewed by third parties beyond what is outlined here. I have the right to voluntarily consent, decline or later revoke this consent at any time. I have the right to request more detailed information

about AI software utilized by contacting The Life Link's Compliance Officer. AI software will not use any of my data to train its model or for any purpose other than creating my documentation.

Signing below indicates that I have reviewed and understand the contents of this document and have received information necessary to make informed decisions. I agree to abide by stated terms and conditions to service provisions. I agree that these provisions and consents will remain in effect until I provide written revocation to The Life Link's Compliance Officer via a letter signed and dated specifying which consents are being revoked.

Client Signature: _____ Date: _____

This Section only pertains if these consents and agreements are being signed by a representative (e.g., Power of Attorney), rather than the client.

_____ _____

Printed Name of Representative (please print) *Relationship to Client*

_____

Reason for signing on behalf of the client (e.g., legal guardian, power of attorney)

_____ _____

Staff Witness Name *Staff Witness Signature*

FOR OFFICE USE ONLY

If applicable, notes regarding client's consent or lack of: ……..

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